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Rich McLean

[NDIS Therapeutic Supports](#) | [Artist-Life-Coach](#) Community Access Facility | 03 9406 797300 | rich@richmclean.com.au



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About my PhD Research

I wear a few different hats and am an artist, human rights-awarded autobiographer & writer, public speaker/recovery expert, and PhD in arts based research and narrative inquiry.

I provide services to clients on the NDIS, and it is my privilege to offer therapeutic support via my unique arts-life-coaching for marginalized people with mental health & other issues in Melbourne.

If you're looking for help for yourself or someone you know who is on the NDIS to get a 'leg up' with a good dose of light-hearted humor and lived experience with secular ethics that hold kindness in the greatest regard—you just found him!

Read here how I can help!



Conferencing
available for
COVID 19
lockdowns.

Your best email?

FREE Audiobook

How can I help you or your client? A confidential free chat is always welcomed!

"Recovery" means something different for everybody."

My name is Rich McLean, I'm an artist, human rights awarded autobiographer, recovery expert, past musician, public speaker and academic. Nowadays I am honoured to work with marginalised people with mental health concerns and/or trauma(s) as a therapeutic arts-life--coach for the NDIS in Melbourne.

[Read how I can help.](#)

It is my passion, my privilege & honour to create a space for my clients for them to gift themselves agency for their best life! This is despite the trauma & the deficit of human existential existence, or mental health and related issues; there is always an upside to rejoice in gratitude & the incremental wins. My modality of therapeutic support works in creative visual ways that allow the client and I to co-creates together--always intuitive and never pushy, working gently but sometimes firmly with compassion.

My modality of therapeutic support can be fun, exciting and wildly self-revealing--and always in a gentle way at the pace of the client.

I aim for there to be a measurable success with my clients in six to twelve weekly 1 x hour sessions. (You will definitely find your 'superpower' amongst other amazing revelations!)

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Call me today on 0406797300

Alternatively, please email rich@richmclean.com.au**PUBLIC SPEAKING & ADVOCACY****A CELEBRATED
AUTHOR OF LIVED
EXPERIENCE**

- Fully insured, Working With Children + Police Checks,
- I have been creating art for 25+ years,
- Past illustrator for both 'The Age' & 'The Herald Sun',

[Read More >](#)**HIGHLY
QUALIFIED IN THE
VISUAL MEDIUM**

- Bachelor of Fine Art, (Drawing Honours),
- Associate Diploma in Computer-Aided Art & Design, (CAAD),
- Masters of Education (A/r/tography), (MEd),

[Read More >](#)**DIVERSITY &
ETHICS ON A
DOCTORAL LEVEL**

- I have passed my PhD (pending changes), via merit-based scholarship,
- Approachable & friendly with gentle secular ethics,
- LGBTIA+ friendly,

[Read More >](#)**A PUBLIC
ADVOCATE
PASSIONATE
ABOUT PEOPLE**

- I have been a public advocate for over twenty years,
- I have a lived experience,
- Human rights awarded autobiographer on recovery,
- No art skills needed!

[Read More >](#)

Don't be shy to get in touch!

A casual chat is always 'on the house' and welcomed!

**HOW I CAN HELP...****A 'PROFESSIONAL - MATE', YOU CAN RELY ON, in CREATIVE therapy, trust**

My passion as a therapist and therapeutic support and psychosocial peer worker are to help people, and I do that in multi-layered ways: I get to know the person by spending quality time within the boundaries of their life. I am unlike other therapists in this regard in that I am a 'professional friend', who is available for emergencies if I am available and where possible; when I take you on as a client, you, your happiness and best life are my priority. Unlike other therapists I do not want to see you forever - I aim to have measurable outcomes with you and your happiness/goals in 6-8 one hourly weekly sessions.

Firstly, I don't care so much for your label; to me, you are a sentient being deserving of compassionate care and understanding & to be heard and acknowledged.

I aim to kick start your life and for you to add value to your life by realising who we are, and celebrating the little victories. I am not here to 'label' you with a diagnosis, although this can sometimes be helpful to know what you have been 'labelled' with. I am not here to give you drugs, and I don't interfere with that from your other supports.

More - so, I holistically listen to your story, value your pain and challenging experiences and utilise an objective view from my therapeutic perspective, allowing you to make sense of your complex life experiences and symptoms, in order for you to understand them; then 'supercharge' your goals and happiness in a way gentle to you and that you are capable of.

It is all delivered with kindness and a good dose of humour!

As an 'arts-life-coach' every one of my clients receives their personalised sketch and notebook that we both co-create together, week after week, noting down graphs and note-taking, utilising a visual medium which is powerful and effective in our realisations of the self and our goals.

Your workbook is covered very much at your own pace and you don't need to be able to draw or be an artist to participate in this type of therapy with me!

Some weeks you may simply want to chat and have a coffee or a meal and that is absolutely fine, other weeks we may hit a sweet spot and really take advantage of the powerful moment and it is in these times I am malleable with my time as a therapist. With you as my priority, I would not dare halt a successful session or meeting if we can get great work done!

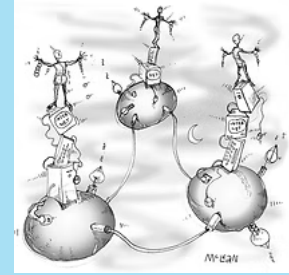
An assessment of all spheres and currencies of your life leads each individuals journey in goals gratitude and ultimately happiness.

Importantly we work together to be aware of any area you may have a deficit in, and we wildly celebrate your achievements and your strengths in the present tense, staying in moments of improvement and success and amplifying them to stitch together a positive narrative week to week.

I receive great joy in seeing people on their path - flying their own spaceship - with gratitude, confidence and my intentions are to allow you to allow yourself the permission to enjoy life with meaning and purpose; and have fun exploring and discovering.

I am a unique kind of therapeutic support probably unlike those you have been in contact with before.

Drawing all my experience and my own strengths I deliver a modality of therapy that is empathic intuitive and unique and often utilises your faith and belief systems which in most cases can be pivotal to your success.



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[Purchase print](#)



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Call or Email for a friendly confidential chat today!

'...Because 'Recovery' means something different for each unique individual.'

For me being creative is necessary for me to acknowledge my feelings and experiences, and I utilise the creative method and modality in my work with the ndis.



PRAISE FOR:

'A CERTAIN BEAUTY IN
UN-RESOLUTION... ART;'
FULL FREE PREVIEW BELOW.

Scott Mcleod - Copywriter

'A Certain Beauty in Un-Resolution' reflects Richard McLean's deeply personal mission of exploration, borne of a life lived with varyingly deliberate and unavoidable intensity. In his ongoing journey towards meaning and truth, his art straddles a seemingly endless parade of media and styles. Pieces question, plead, embrace and reject. They mock, celebrate, erupt and scurry into corners. But throughout the passionate and chaotic visual commentary there is undeniable consistency - his work is unfailingly visceral, immediate and evocative - like the man himself.'

JIM PAVLIDISwww.jimpavlidis.com

'A Certain Beauty In Un-Resolution' is a substantial life-affirming body of work by an artist who is not a passive observer, but a fully-engaged participant. Employing a visual language developed over 20 years that is urgent, sensitive and highly refined, Richard McLean's visceral response to his world is often confronting. He utilises his considerable technical prowess across traditional and digital media to not merely record life's myriad nooks and crannies but to question them, with surprising results.'

RMIT Classification: Trusted

"A Certain Beauty in Un-Resolution" is Rich McLean's creative opus which launches us into his aesthetic and affective worlds with the words *"Here's to the crazy ones. The misfits. The rebels. The troublemakers."* I don't know any viewer/readers who would not find themselves in those words and in the images that follow. McLean's evocative drawings, paintings, digital media and multimodal artworks breathe with a life well-lived, a life immersed in the messiness, joy and heartache of contemporary urban culture. The sheer range of styles, colours, forms, and subjects over these vibrant 232 pages is a visual journey through the viscera of everyday life. Each page heaves with life. I highly recommend this compendium to anyone interested in the arts, wellbeing, resilience and

This site was designed with the **WIX**.com website builder. Create your website today.[Start Now](#)**Anne Harris**Principal Research Fellow, RMIT
UniversityDirector, Creative Agency research
lab www.creativeresearchhub.com

A CERTAIN BEAUTY IN UN-RESOLUTION... ART; (PREVIEW LOADING PLEASE WAIT)



404

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- (Physical Copy)
- Hardcover Dustjacket
- hardcover ImageWrap

Creativity is the life source of acutely sensitive people. Without creativity, taking another breath to greet the day can be beyond challenging. We all need to communicate our story in some way and Rich's book 'A Certain Beauty In Un-Resolution... ART'; explores his way of communicating how he views the multidimensional landscape of life and beyond. Art is a channel of release and exploration. Rich has never been shy in exploring beyond the boundaries of normality. No true artist ever can.

Odette Nightsky.

www.contemporaryshaman.net

I have not only a lived experience of 'non-ordinary reality', but have over 25 + years of Public Advocacy on Mental-Health Recovery & solid values.

I value freedom, creativity and despite inevitable suffering, and the deficient realities, that happiness is possible for all, no matter what the situation.

I believe that recovery from mental health issues is not only possible but probable, and it means something different for different people!

I believe through empowering the self through art, talking, walking and conversation that we can become further self-actualised and *not just survive but thrive*, no matter who we are or the difficulties we face.



I HAVE WRITTEN FOR, BEEN FEATURED IN, SPOKEN FOR, OR WORKED FOR THE FOLLOWING ORGANISATIONS & INSTITUTIONS:



I was interviewed for medium.com by Rebecca Chamaa for an article on my life and work 'Bright Lights and Dark Corners'



AUSTRALIAN
PARLIAMENT HOUSE

I spoke in Australian parliament with SANE Australia



I exhibited at Gasworks in 2012 with a solo show 'Return from narcissism' and also in 2013 with a

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under the headline, 'Mental Health hits the Political Frontline', but they reneged to report that I also advocated for refugees literally trying to bury themselves alive.



I have spoken at The Royal Melbourne Hospital on various topics, including the risks of cannabis and psychosis, and also through my fundraising work with my book, 'Grogan the Monster in... What Do You Love?', with 25% of proceeds benefiting the banksia Unit, Child and Adolescent Mental Health.



I did a Master of Education at Victoria University, then was awarded a scholarship to go on and do my Dr of Philosophy. I was extremely grateful and I have just found out I passed the PhD subject to changes.



I was interviewed on JJJ many times, on 'hack' with Robbie Buck, and Rachel Kerr on a special on recovery in mental health.



I was invited by SBS to fly up to Sydney and speak about Drugs and mental health with Jenny Brocky. The show was live - and unfortunately I was set up. I wanted to talk to them about the risks of marijuana and psychosis and then right at the top of the show they cut from a poor man whose child had died from a drug overdose to me - essentially putting me on the spot and shaming me, making me look bad.



I was interviewed for 'The Good Men project' by Naomi Fryers, with her article, 'Follow Your Passions to Make Life Bearable and Find Your True Authentic Self' I also wrote an article for my PhD titled 'Giving Up the Fags: A Self-Reflexive Speech on Critical Auto-ethnography About the Shame of Growing up Gay/Sexual Abuse' and it was published also on TGMP



I spoke with over 500 young people about mental health recovery when my autobiography was published, and also taught a session for the more interested students on articulating ideas in writing.



I worked for Royal Melbourne Hospital for some time and often went to Forensicare to comment on clients art practices and advocate for recovery.



I spoke on RRR about 'Art & Mental Illness, (Skillness!)', with Richard Watts for Smart Arts.



I have done many speeches and group activities for The Richmond Fellowship, both in Melbourne, to Warrnambool.



I donated many works to the then Cunningham Dax Collection, which is now The Dax Centre. The documentary on my life and art was made possible by The Dax Centre.



I was a 'SANE speaker', and did many talks for them. I was also awarded SANE Australia's 'Book of the Year', 2003. I worked for them as an advocate and consultant.



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VICTORIAN CURRICULUM AND
ASSESSMENT AUTHORITY



When i worked at The dax Centre, I did a presentation to the head people at VCAA who were the people that decided what curriculum was appropriate when selecting texts and media for high school students.



I have spoken many times on the ABC, across triple J and rural radio, and my autobiography was converted to an abridged version for the 'Life Matters' program with Julie McCrossin. It was played a few times on the network because of how people were engaged with it. The Audiobook is available for free on this website.

Clinical Psychiatry News

I was featured in an edition of the international 'Clinical Psychiatry News' for my 'Visionary Art', and about non ordinary reality and creativity.



I worked for 'The Age' as a News Graphics Artist & Illustrator for nearly five years & also featured in articles and stories in my advocacy role - essentially being the news too!



I was interviewed on JOY a couple of times about my art shows and advocacy work.



I spoke at the School of Religious and Philosophical Studies numerous times at McGill University in Canada. On the panel were world renowned experts on so called 'schizophrenia', and I was so warmly received they invited me back to speak about art and psychosis to a group of people who had to read my autobiography for their course.



I did numerous talks at EPPIC with young people about drugs and mental health who were at risk of psychosis.



Arts Access Australia

I was interviewed by Arts Access Australia, although I question the term 'disability. It may actually be 'ability', and my 'mental illness', is perhaps my 'mental skillness.'



I have linked in with Midsumma Gay and lesbian festival on a number of occasions.



THE CHILDREN'S
BOOK COUNCIL
OF AUSTRALIA

SINCE 1945 — YOUR CONNECTION TO STORY
I was linked to the childrens book council through my work with The State Library of Victoria.

THE AGE

INDEPENDENT. ALWAYS.

I was a News graphics Artist and Illustrator for 'The Age' newspaper for nearly five years. During and after my time there I was often the topic of the news instead of creating the visuals for it.



I was interviewed by 'The Makers of Melbourne', who wrote: 'Richard McLean is a total surprise package. An artist cloaked in the outer shell of a man of otherwise ordinary appearance. Yet the very word — ordinary — is at stark odds with the voice expressed in Richard's visual and written work.'



Australian
Human Rights
Commission

everyone, everywhere, everyday

I was awarded a 'Highly Commended non-fiction' for my autobiography 'Recovered, Not Cured, a journey through schizophrenia.'



City of KINGSTON

I worked closely with city of Kingston with my 2010 exhibition 'Back to basics', at Morabbin Town hall. The catalogue from that show can be found on this site.



THE UNIVERSITY OF
MELBOURNE

I did a Bachelor of Fine Art at Victorian College for the Arts



VICTORIAN COLLEGE
OF THE ARTS

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I was interviewed on 2SM by Tricia Duffield

3AW⁶⁹³
NEWS TALK

I was interviewed on 'Nightline' by Phillip Brady & Bruce Mansfield



I performed a talk at baw Baw youth Network.

Carers NSW asked me to fly to Dubbo in outback NSW where I gave a speech in the town hall.

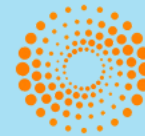
My books can be researched at The State Library of Victoria.

HUFFPOST

I wrote for the Huffington Post in: 'Happiness Advice From an Artist Living With Schizophrenia', although having researched it thoroughly in my PhD I do not believe the term is factual and the label actually harms people. I see 'non-ordinary-reality', through a holistic shamanistic lens.

My book: 'Grogan the Monster in... What Do You Love?', gives 25% of profits and royalties directly to The banksia Unit for Child and Adolescent mental health at The Royal Children's Hospital. At my book launch in Footscray I raised over \$1000 for them - the first fundraiser the centre had had.

I was interviewed by James Valentine

**REUTERS TV**

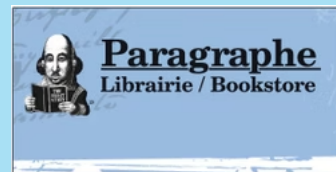
Video interview with Frankie Fathers for Reuters.

I did many presentations and group chats to people at Drygen in Parkville who were at risk of psychosis. It was attached to the Mental health research Centre where I also regularly spoke with groups of year 11 and 12 students.

EPPIC is a centre which supports young people at risk of psychosis and I did many talks to young people here.

EPPIC
Statewide
Services**Herald Sun**

I worked as a news graphics Artist and Illustrator for 'The Herald Sun', and later they were utterly slanderous towards me-by publishing my self reflexive account of my experience with schizophrenia - which was a triumphant story of recovery - with the derogatory and slanderous headline of 'MY DESCENT INTO MADNESS.' I was at The Age by then - and shortly after they fired me for no reason.



When I toured Montreal speaking at McGill University in Canada, I also did other talks around town. La Paragraphe Bookshop was one of these speaking opportunities.

Spectrum *Fm*

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I was interviewed by John Weeks

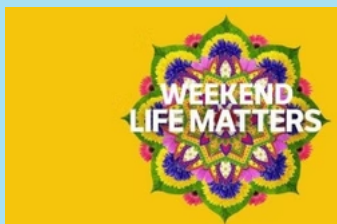
I have appeared on channel 31 a few times spreading a recovery focussed perspective



I was on Good Morning Australia twice, once with Steve Leidman for the launch of my book, and the other for an exhibition i was having.



I spoke to the clients of Douglas Hospital in Montreal at the inpatients clinic.



An abridged version of my autobiography was on this program in a 5-part series. I read it in the first person, and it is free on this website.



I talked about my upcoming talk in Dubbo town hall.



Phillip Brady & Bruce Mansfield



Interviewed by Tricia Duffield



I did many talks at the MHRI to year 11 and 12 people on art and mental illness and shared my experience via art.



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confidential casual chat!

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